

There are a lot of misconceptions about software on OS X. Most importantly, quite a lot of people believe that the Mac platform suffers from a lack of quality software. Their views stem from the 1990s, when there really was a problem of lack of software for the Mac. However, today, there happens to be a large list of software available for the platform.

With the launch of Intel Macs, you can run Windows applications using virtualisation tools like Parallels alongside your Macintosh applications. You can also use software like Darwinie and Crossover Mac to run Windows applications natively on OS X!

We list here some software that we believe are essential for the Macintosh.

8.1 Internet

8.1.1 Browsers

Safari

Safari is the default browser that ships with Mac OS X. It was first introduced in OS 10.3—“Panther”—in 2003. With OS 10.4—“Tiger”, Apple dropped Internet Explorer, and Safari became the only browser included in OS X. Safari is based on Konqueror’s KHTML engine. Konqueror is a free, open source browser that ships with KDE.

Safari is tightly integrated with OS X, so it’s more than satisfactory in the performance department. It boasts of a clean, minimalist interface with a cus-



Screenshot: Mac OS 10.4 running Safari.jpg